Staff answers for the neutral evidence

Tuesday 19 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W03

N1–N5 are wholly invented teaching materials about a fictional book display. They describe no real person or event. They are not survivor testimony, a composite or a model of anyone's Holocaust experience.

Who when and why

N1 is an invented volunteer's view from the door during setup. They left before opening. N2 identifies a note-taker, a checked written account, fourteen days between 6 and 20 October, and a newsletter purpose. The account is selective; a purpose does not automatically make it false. No recording or real narrator exists.

Claim checks

Claim	Comparison and careful judgement
Three boxes	N1 and independently created N4 agree within the fiction. N3 planned four, but a plan is not proof. Three is supported by two separate scenario records.
Green cloth	N1 and N3 mention green, but one is recall and the other a plan. N4 says blue. N5 repeats N1. Keep the colour unresolved without further independent evidence.
Opening time	N1 is unsure and the witness left before opening. N3 planned 10:00. N4 records 10:05 from a helper who stayed; it is better placed for this claim but can still err.
N5 agreement	The newsletter used N1. Do not count copied words as an independent second witness.

What not to infer

Do not decide the witness lied, saw a different cloth or read the plan: none is established. A discrepancy limits a specific claim; it does not erase every useful detail. The fictional sources are a teaching tool, not research evidence for any real event.

Teacher written model

N1 is useful for the setup seen from the door. N2 says it was recorded fourteen days later for a newsletter. N4 separately supports the three-box detail. The cloth colour differs, so I would check that claim further. The witness left before opening and was unsure of the time. I cannot use N1 alone to prove the opening time.

Applying the method without testimony

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General application only

No survivor testimony appears in any format in this pack. Do not supply an invented quotation, pseudonymous composite or paraphrased experience to fill that absence. Ask about method, not what a survivor said.

Why record: possible reasons include preserving a voice, remembrance, research and education. An actual recording's purpose must be checked rather than assumed. Accounts can preserve individual perspectives which a formal record may omit. One person cannot speak for everyone.

Who and when: identify narrator, interviewer, recorder, editor, event period and recording date where known. Consider questions, selection, translation and editing. Distinguish what a witness directly experienced from later learning, without dismissing the latter automatically.

Memory and time: later recording does not mean false; exact dates or minor details may need checking. Early recording is not a guarantee either. Do not judge truth from tears, calmness, confidence, fluency or visible emotion. Do not infer a person's mental state from delivery.

Corroboration: compare specific claims with independent documents and accounts. Ask who created each document, why and what it omits. A perpetrator-created record can distort or conceal; being official does not make it neutral. Missing paperwork is not proof that an experience did not occur. Do not turn careful checking into a denial debate.

Respect and dignity

Listen without mockery or interruptions. Use careful language about the evidence and what remains unknown. Preserve personhood; do not rank suffering, demand personal disclosure or ask pupils to imagine victim experiences. The neutral task transfers questions, not the emotional meaning or conditions of Holocaust experience.

The school's chosen memorial-day archive may be used live by the teacher if the school approves. This is optional. The pack names no archive, title, organisation or address.

If live use is approved, follow Planner. If omitted, assess source-method practice and general application only. The exact scheme outcome remains printed, but attainment and archive use are never assumed.

Assessment sensitive response and follow up

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Hinge

N1 and N5 both mention a green cloth. N5 used N1. Which judgement fits? A: Two independent witnesses confirm green. B: The same claim has been repeated, so we still need a separate check. C: All eyewitness accounts must be false.

B. N5 depends on N1; it is not independent corroboration. A overcounts evidence and C rejects far too much. Ask both learners privately for a reason. If needed, trace the N1-to-N5 link, then use the parallel question before independent work.

N3 planned an opening at 10:00. Does this prove the display opened then? No: it records intention. N4 records 10:05 from a helper who stayed. Check a further independent event record if available; neither a plan nor a log is automatically complete.

Common finish

In your book, evaluate N1 using the six checks. Use N2 for context and compare N3, N4 and N5. Write a short judgement with two card codes, one supported claim and one limit. Add two general points: why survivor testimony matters and how historians can check it while listening with respect.

Accept short notes and a reasoned conclusion. Supported work may use frames or exact directed scribing; record help. Aspire should give a stronger limitation or further check, not simply more words. A joint answer is not evidence for both pupils.

Closing reflection

Possible response: remembrance values people as individuals; I can listen with respect, check where a claim comes from and seek safe adult help if I hear antisemitism. No survivor words, story or image are needed. Do not equate everyday unkindness with the Holocaust.

Care

Agree a discreet PAUSE signal, supervising adult, quiet place and private return check before teaching. Keep both pupils supervised. If a sole adult cannot supervise separate spaces, use a calm place in the room or pause the whole group while seeking usual support. Never send a pupil away alone.

If a pupil is distressed, stop the demand, acknowledge it calmly and offer the agreed route without sanction or public explanation. Do not probe or insist on a historical recap. Follow existing safeguarding arrangements for disclosures and use the usual private recording system.

Interrupt antisemitism calmly and firmly. Name the harm without repeating a slur; hostility towards Jewish people is unacceptable. Correct the falsehood briefly and follow school procedures. Do not debate Holocaust denial or require pupils to defend victims' rights. Evaluating a source is not a debate about whether the Holocaust happened.

For flippancy or laughter, stop and reset respectful listening. A nervous response is possible, but harm still needs addressing. Follow up privately, check those affected and use existing procedures for targeted, repeated or serious incidents. Avoid shaming or guessing motives.

Neutral alternative: 08:30 reading, 10:00 break, 12:00 lunch, 14:00 club; pencil/book and cup/plate by use. Keep supervision and private re-entry. It is not history evidence.

Offer to the Communication portfolio. Record R only after the learner gives an idea, an adult audience replies with one NS (next step), and the learner responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. Record E only after actual banking. Keep the response mode and actual help. A partner answer does not establish both learners' understanding.

Method and care were checked against public professional guidance outside this bundle. No archive title, organisation, address, testimony text or imagery is redistributed. The owner's stricter care brief controls this lesson.

Made by Matt